



# ENG507

**Mid-Term**

## ABSTRACT

*This comprehensive collection of notes is accurately crafted to empower students to excel academically, ensuring they achieve a minimum of 80% marks in their examinations. The content is organized with clarity and precision, focusing on key concepts, critical analyses, and practical applications tailored to the syllabus. These notes serve as a reliable resource for both thorough preparation and last-minute revision. Designed to inspire confidence and mastery, this guide is an essential tool for students striving for academic excellence.*

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### **Q. Consonant vs Vowel**

- Vowels: Least obstruction to airflow; occur at syllable centers.
- Consonants: Partial or complete obstruction; usually at syllable edges

### **Q. Broad and Narrow Transcription**

- Broad (phonemic): /pin/ – general, no physical detail.
- Narrow (phonetic): [p<sup>h</sup>ɪn] – detailed, includes articulatory/auditory features

### **Q. Transcribed Word**

A word written using IPA symbols. Example: ‘this’ = /ðɪs/ (broad), [ðɪs̺] (narrow)

### **Q. Three Forms of Vowels**

- Stressed – fully pronounced.
- Unstressed – different in quality.
- Reduced – central schwa-like vowel /ə/

### **Q. Articulatory Phonetics**

Studies how speech sounds are produced using vocal organs (tongue, lips, velum, etc.).

### **Q. Lax Vowels**

Weak vowels produced with less muscular effort (e.g., /ɪ/, /æ/, /ʊ/); short and indistinct compared to tense vowels

### **Q. Characteristics of Suprasegmentals**

Features above individual sounds: pitch, loudness, tempo, juncture, syllable, rhythm, stress.

### **Q. Main Speech Production Feature**

Includes airstream mechanism, voicing (phonation), place and manner of articulation, oro-nasal process, etc.

### **Q. American Vowels**

American English differs in:

More rhotic (r-colored) vowels.

Diphthongization of tense vowels like [i] → [ɪ] in "heed"

English Vowels

BBC English has:

7 short vowels: /ɪ/, /e/, /æ/, /ʌ/, /ɒ/, /ʊ/, /ə/

5 long vowels: /i:/, /ɑ:/, /ɔ:/, /u:/, /ɜ:/

8 diphthongs: /eɪ/, /aɪ/, /ɔɪ/, /əʊ/, /aʊ/, /ɪə/, /eə/, /ʊə/

### **Q. Auditory Phonetics**

Studies how we hear and recognize speech sounds, including brain and ear functions

### **Q. Alveolar**

Sounds produced with the tongue against the alveolar ridge, e.g., /t/, /d/, /s/, /z/, /n/, /l/

### **Q. Stress**

Stress is defined as the degree of prominence a syllable receives, caused by loudness, length, pitch, and vowel quality

### **Q. Nasals**

Produced by airflow through the nose, e.g., /m/, /n/, /ŋ/

### **Q. Diphthongs**

Vowel glides that move from one quality to another (e.g., /aɪ/ in "buy")

## Q. Velaric Airstream Mechanism

Airstream produced by tongue movement against the velum. Used in clicks (common in African languages)

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